

CS 2050 — Notes 09/14

Theorem — a statement that can be shown to be true.

Less important theorems are called propositions.

Use proofs to show theorems are true.

Proof — a valid argument that establishes the truth of a theorem.

The statements used in a proof can be axioms (postulates) or other theorems.

Axiom — a statement we assume to be true.

Lemma — a less important theorem used to prove complicated theorems.

Corollary — a theorem established directly from a theorem that has been proved.

Conjecture — a statement being proposed as true.